



*Every mark on a page is an argument about what should happen next.*

FIG. 01 — UNTITLED SURFACE, ARCHIVE PRINT

PDF marker demo

## 01 — ON PROOFING MARKS

**B**efore a page is finished, it is covered in the marks of people arguing with it. A caret shows where a word belongs. A looping line shows where a paragraph should move — and somewhere in this very sentence the words PDF marker demo sit quietly among the rest, doing nothing more than confirming they can be found. A red circle around a comma is not decoration — it is an instruction left for the next person who touches the sheet. This is the oldest kind of interface: annotation as conversation between drafts.

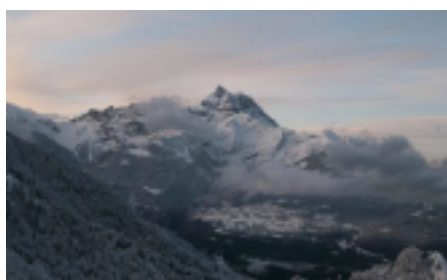


FIG. 02 — DETAIL, UNCOATED STOCK — PDF marker demo

Printers once kept a shared vocabulary of these gestures so that a mark made in one shop meant the same thing in another — the way the phrase PDF marker demo means the same thing wherever it lands on this sheet. A stet undid a correction. A stroke through a capital lowered it. None of these symbols described the content of the page — only what should happen to it before the next pass through the press.

What survives from that vocabulary today is mostly invisible to a reader. Registration marks sit outside the trim line. Colour bars run along an edge that will be cut away. A crop mark is a note from one machine to another, never meant to be read by a person at all — closer to a handshake than a sentence.

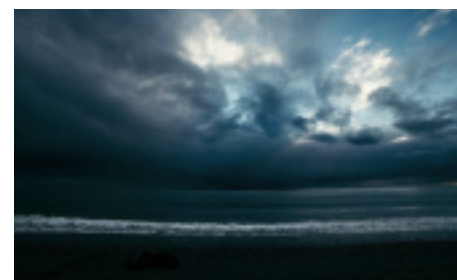


FIG. 03 — ALIGNMENT STUDY, GRID 08

A watermark works the opposite way: it is meant to be found, but only once, and only by someone who already knows to look for it —